

Apply for a Science Corps Fellowship - Entry #3248

Name

Alia Sajani

Emailalia.a.sajani.gr@dartmouth.edu**Gender**

Female

City, state, and country of residence

Hanover, New Hampshire, USA

Nationality

United States

When did or will you finish your PhD?

January 2024

University Education

PhD in Immunology, Dartmouth College, expected January 2024

Bachelor of Arts in Biology, Grinnell College, 2016

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps fellow?

During the 5.5 years of my PhD, I spent my time developing myself as a scientist by rigorously exploring a set of scientific questions. In this time, while I have grown, and been part of a scientific and academic community, I have felt a lack of impact of my science, and day-to-day work on bettering my community. As someone who didn't have access to great educational opportunities prior to moving to the US at the age of 16, I recognize how important early education is on shaping the trajectory of students' futures. I also value encouraging students from diverse backgrounds to join and flourish in the sciences. Both my undergraduate and graduate experiences made very clear to me that college is much too late of a time to start encouraging scientists

of color, and from resource lacking countries, to get excited about careers in science. I also hope that through outreach, I can help open doors to the next generation of scientists.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship.

After my undergraduate studies, I spent the summer as a camp counselor and yoga instructor at a camp for high school students. I have also volunteered virtually to advise and run workshops for high school students on the college application process. I was a judge for a middle school science fair. During my graduate studies, I have held multiple leadership positions. I was the Secretary of the Dartmouth Writers Society and the campus representative for the New England Graduate Women in Science and Engineering consortium. I also taught an undergraduate level laboratory-based course on genetics.

To develop my skills in scientific communication, I have engaged in multiple science writing endeavors. During a study abroad program in college, I was a science writing intern at the National Institute for Medical Research (now the Francis Crick Institute) in London, where I wrote about recent research publications coming out of the institute. While at the NIH, I continued developing my science writing skills as a contributing writer for The Catalyst, the NIH's intramural research magazine. Then during graduate school, I participated in several science writing programs organized by the National Association for Science Writers, where I worked with editors to publish articles. I also write and edit for Immunobites, an immunology blog run by graduate students and postdoctoral fellows, targeted at helping a general audience understand complex immunological concepts. I also took a science communication class in graduate school and participated in the StoryCollider's week-long workshop on how to become a better science communicator.

I believe that my extensive experience in scientific communication, as well as having worked with high school students before, will allow me to carry out a successful fellowship. In addition, since I was born and brought up in Kenya, and having spent half of high school there, I understand the differences and lack of educational opportunities in resource lacking countries.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Doing science in industry
Administrative role in industry or academia
In science outreach
Other

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (two year) and long-term (ten year) future.

In the long term, I am planning on pursuing a career in science writing, either as a journalist or medical writer. I hope to improve my science communications skills as a Science Corps mentor, and I'm planning on spending the next couple years pursuing a career in science writing. Throughout my career, I plan on volunteering in outreach positions to continue encouraging students from minoritized backgrounds to pursue science.

CV/Resume[Alia Sajani Resume mentorship science.pdf](#)**How did you find out about Science Corps?**

Twitter

Any other comments/questions?

Start date: February or March 2024

Location: Morocco, but open to other locations too

[Science Corps](#)